

Google

The only competitor that owns the whole stack — custom silicon, frontier models, developer platform and consumer distribution · cloud.google.com

1998

Founded

\$24.8B

Cloud rev (Q2 26)

+82%

Cloud growth

\$514B

Cloud backlog

~90%

Fortune 100 on Gemini Ent.

01 Overview

Google Cloud accelerated from 48% growth in Q4 2025 to 63% in Q1 2026 to 82% in Q2, with backlog reaching \$514B. Gemini processes roughly 22 billion tokens per minute through direct API use, and nearly 90% of the Fortune 100 use Gemini Enterprise.

Offering: Google Cloud infrastructure and the Gemini model family, plus the Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform (formerly Vertex AI), Workspace Studio for no-code agent building, and custom silicon — Ironwood TPUs, with an eighth generation splitting into Broadcom-designed training chips and MediaTek-designed inference chips.

Key facts

HQ: Mountain View, California (Alphabet Inc.)

Ownership: Segment of Alphabet Inc. (NASDAQ: GOOGL, GOOG)

Revenue: Alphabet passed \$400B of annual revenue for the first time in FY2025. Q2 2026 revenue was \$119.8B, up 24%, with operating income of \$40.8B, up 30%. Google Cloud reached \$24.77B in Q2 2026, up 82%, with operating income of \$8.81B against \$2.83B a year earlier

Web: cloud.google.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Sundar Pichai (Chief Executive Officer, Alphabet & Google) · Thomas Kurian (Chief Executive Officer, Google Cloud)

Digital twin: Via partners · **GenAI:** Yes (Gemini, full stack)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Enterprise AI adoption	Gemini Enterprise, the enterprise agent and assistant platform, adopted across large corporates. KPMG reported 90% Gemini Enterprise adoption among its own employees.	Nearly 90% of Fortune 100 companies using Gemini Enterprise; paid monthly active users grew 40% quarter over quarter in Q1 2026	Link
Cloud & AI infrastructure	Google Cloud infrastructure and enterprise AI solutions, including TPU system sales, with growth accelerating through three consecutive quarters.	Q4 2025 \$17.7B (+48%) → Q1 2026 \$20.0B (+63%) → Q2 2026 \$24.77B (+82%); backlog reached \$514B, with just over half expected to convert within 24...	Link
Model usage at scale	First-party Gemini models consumed through direct API use by customers, alongside the Gemini app on the consumer side.	~22 billion tokens per minute in Q2 2026, up from 16 billion a quarter earlier and 10 billion in Q4 2025; over 9 million developers building monthly;	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Amazon Web Services · Anthropic · Meta · Microsoft · NVIDIA · OpenAI · Perplexity · xAI

Where it sits: Kurian's competitive argument is that rivals hand customers components rather than an assembled platform, and the vertical integration behind that claim is real — Google is the only player owning custom silicon, frontier models, developer platform and consumer distribution under one roof.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Google Cloud is near-certain to be present in some PortCos already, so the practical question is consolidated commercial terms rather than a first introduction.
BlackRock	No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of GOOGL/GOOG only.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Enterprise demand is outrunning capacity, which is why capex guidance keeps rising. Roughly 75% of Google Cloud customers were using AI products as of Q1 2026, and the expansion pattern Kurian describes — \$100 of commitment becoming more than \$150 of spend

What supports the story

- Cloud growth accelerated across three consecutive quarters to 82%, with operating income tripling year over year to \$8.81B
- \$514B backlog, with just over half expected to convert within 24 months — revenue visibility no competitor discloses at this scale
- Genuine full-stack vertical integration: custom TPUs, frontier models, agent platform and consumer distribution

What to pressure-test

- 2026 capital expenditure guidance raised to \$195–205B, and free cash flow turned negative in Q2 2026
- Backlog figures vary noticeably between sources and presentation dates — use Alphabet's filings, not conference coverage
- Enterprise support and account management remain the historical objection against Google relative to AWS and Azure

Employee: Not covered in this pass — Google headcount is not broken out separately in the results reviewed and no reliable employer-review data was gathered. Treat as a gap.

Sources: Google public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.